Name – Azeez Abidemi Adigun

Course - HLSC 3P94

Title - Teamwork as the Heart of Healthcare: My Path to Administrative Leadership

Before this course, I thought teamwork in healthcare was just people doing their jobs side by side. But week 5 topic on teamwork removed that idea from me. Mach et al. (2021) say a team is “a group of individuals with complementary skills who work interdependently toward a common goal”. The slides from (Pilato 2025) added that it’s about communication and trust, not just the end result. This essay is about how that clicked for me, tied to my own life, and got me thinking about healthcare management in a new way.

The Week 5 reading by Mach et al. (2021) laid out different team types, like staff/crew, remote-controlled groups, coordinated groups, and real teams based on how close they are. For example, nurses on different shifts might not talk much, just passing notes, while a surgery team has to be in sync or it would lead to a disaster. I used to think any group was a team, but now I see it’s about how different they are. In admin, people handling patient files might only need quick check-ins, not deep chats. It’s interesting how teamwork shifts depending on the job. A clinic could fall apart if staff don’t connect, and a surgery team is built on that deep collaboration

Team interdependence grabbed my attention. Mach et al. (2021) explain that when people rely on each other like in a busy clinic, it’s powerful but tricky if it’s disorganized. (Pilato’s 2025) slides warned about downsides, like too many meetings or people resisting change. Imagine specialists arguing over a new patient care plan. If their roles overlap, it’s chaos.

(Pilato 2025) calls that a “cost of teamwork,” like time wasted on pointless talks. Good teams need trust and a way to fix problems fast. I never saw that before, but now it’s obvious why some groups get along and others do not.

The strategic planning slides (Pilato, 2025) really opened my eyes to how teamwork fits into the bigger hospital picture like figuring out what the organization’s good at, setting goals, and making sure everything lines up. Teams aren’t just there to do the work, they make sure new technology, systems, or policies actually stick. I had not thought about how the type of team needs to match the task. Like, if you're rolling out a new patient data system, you need a team that’s close and works closely together. Now it makes sense: success depends on matching the mission with the right kind of teamwork.

I saw this myself when I volunteered at a clinic back when i was in Nigeria. The staff barely communicated across roles, and it honestly felt like they were just a bunch of individuals moving around, which reminds me of (Mach et al.’s 2021) idea of a “remote-controlled group.” That lack of connection caused silly but frustrating errors, like asking patients the same questions multiple times. According to Pilato (2025), that’s a classic teamwork failure as it wastes time and drains everyone’s energy. Patients were visibly annoyed, and the staff seemed totally burned out. If they had just taken time to coordinate better, things would have gone way more smoothly. (Pilato’s 2025) also talked about motivation, which hit hard here when people don’t feel like part of a real team, it kills their sense of purpose. That experience showed me how messy things get without strong teamwork, and how much smoother and more meaningful it could be when people actually work together.

One day, a patient's medication list got totally messed up because the nurse and admin weren't on the same page. It threw everything off and delayed the whole process. I remember watching the patient sit there, confused and frustrated, and I felt horrible. If they had followed something like (Pilato's 2025) advice on clearly defining roles and maintaining open communication, that mix-up probably wouldn't have happened. That moment stuck with me. It wasn't just a system error it directly affected someone. That experience made me realize that I want to fix things like that in my future career.

Now, I'm genuinely excited to bring these ideas into healthcare administration. (Pilato 2025) highlights how important skills like active listening, conflict resolution, and thoughtful team planning are to keep things running smoothly. If I were organizing a hospital team, I'd make sure every role was clearly defined, and open communication was the norm and definitely no repeats of a clinic chaos. I'd also work on creating a safe space for people to speak up, which can lead to innovation like brainstorming better solutions. (Qin et al. 2023) also emphasizes that good people management is a key piece in improving healthcare. I would use some of the trackers from course aterials to monitor team performance and stay on top of goals.

I'm also really interested in the idea of virtual teams, like the ones (Mach et al. 2021) talk about. I could see myself leading a project that uses tech to support rural communities. (Mach et al. 2021) point out that we need more research on virtual teamwork, and (Qin et al. 2023) noted how scattered healthcare management studies are. With the way healthcare is shifting toward big data, telecare, and tech-heavy solutions. strong, well-

managed virtual teams are going to be essential. I want to be part of that shift and help build teams that actually work.

This course seriously changed how I think about teamwork in healthcare. It's not just about getting along, it's about planning, structure, and having the right systems in place. That clinic experience showed me what falls apart when teamwork is missing. But now, with the frameworks and strategies we've learned, I feel ready to bring structure, clarity, and energy to the teams I'll work with. I've got new tools to make care better for patients, and that's what motivates me most.

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